

Class 10th | English



Footprints Without Feet

A QUESTION OF TRUST

LECTURE - 2

QUESTIONS

1. Why does he steal every year?

Ans. He steals every year so that he could buy the rare and expensive books that he loved to collect.

QUESTIONS

2. Did you begin to suspect, before the end of the story, that the lady was not the person Horace Danby took her to be? If so, at what point did you realise this and how?

Ans. Yes, we begin to suspect before the end of the story that the lady was not the person Horace Danby took her to be. Our suspicion begin when she stays calm upon seeing an intruder in her home. Moreover, she did not call the police and instead asked Horace to take out all the jewels from the safe. Besides, it seemed highly unlikely that she would forget the number to open the safe. Therefore, it was evident, before the story ended that the lady was not the person who she claimed to be.

QUESTIONS

3. What are the subtle ways in which the lady manages to deceive Horace Danby into thinking she is the lady of the house? Why doesn't Horace suspect that something is wrong?

Ans. The lady's confident walk, her familiarity with the dog Sherry, her act of touching up her make-up and the ease with which she picks a cigarette from the right place are enough to deceive Horace into thinking that she was the lady of the house. Horace does not suspect anything.

QUESTIONS

4. "Horace Danby was good and respectable - but not completely honest". Why do you think this description is apt for Horace? Why can't he be categorised as a typical thief?

Ans. Horace Danby was good and respectable but not completely honest is an apt description for Horace. He was a respectable lock-maker who had a good reputation in the society. However, Horace was also an unusual thief. He had a hobby of collecting rare and expensive books which he fulfilled by robbing a safe every year. Thus, he was not a completely honest man. Horace cannot be categorised as a typical thief because he was not a regular offender. He robbed once a year and only took what was required.

QUESTIONS

5. Horace Danby was a meticulous planner but still he faltered. Where did he go wrong and why?

Ans. It is true that Horace Danby was a meticulous planner but he had faltered in the robbery he was carrying out in Shotover Grange.

This failure was because of the lady in red who deceived and tricked Horace into believing that she was the lady of the house. Horace, who had carefully planned the robbery, did not care to get any information about the housemates. Consequently, he blindly believed that the lady in red was the lady of the house. So, when she suddenly appeared, Horace carelessly opened the safe without his gloves.

QUESTIONS

6. Do you think Horace Danby was unfairly punished, or that he deserved what he got?

Ans. I think Horace Danby deserved what he got. A crime is a crime, no matter if it is committed for your own benefit or for somebody else's benefit.

QUESTIONS

7. Horace had served his sentence in prison _____.

- (a) 20 years ago ✓
- (b) 5 years ago ✓
- (c) 15 years ago ✓
- (d) 20 years ago ✓

QUESTIONS

Ans. (c) 15 years ago

QUESTIONS

8. Why do you think Horace had to serve his first prison sentence?
- (a) He stole a rare and an expensive book. ✗
 - (b) He stole a safe to buy books. ✓
 - (c) He stole a painting. ✗
 - (d) He was caught red-handed while selling locks. ✗

QUESTIONS

Ans. (b) He stole a safe to buy books.

QUESTIONS

9. Where did the housekeeper hang the keys?
- (a) At the kitchen door ✓
 - (b) At the keyboard
 - (c) Behind the door
 - (d) None of these

QUESTIONS

Ans. (a) At the kitchen door

QUESTIONS

- 10.** Where had the servants at Shotover Grange gone that afternoon?
- (a)** To their homes
 - (b)** To the park
 - (c)** To the market
 - (d)** To the cinema

QUESTIONS

Ans. (d) To the cinema

QUESTIONS

- 11.** How many hours did Horace have before the servants return?
- (a)** One hour
 - (b)** Five hours
 - (c)** Two hours
 - (d)** Four hours

QUESTIONS

Ans. (d) Four hours

QUESTIONS

12. Read the following extract carefully and answer the questions that follow.

How foolish people are when they own valuable things, Horace thought. A magazine article had described this house, giving a plan of all the rooms and a picture of this room. The writer had even mentioned that the painting hid a safe! But Horace found that the flowers were hindering him in his work. He buried his face in his handkerchief. Then he heard a voice say from the doorway, "What is it? A cold or hay fever?" Before he could think, Horace said, "Hay fever," and found himself sneezing again. The voice went on, "You can cure it with a special treatment, you know, if you find out just what plant gives you the disease. I think you'd better see a doctor, if you're serious about your work. I heard you from the top of the house just now."

File

QUESTIONS

i. When Horace was trying to work, who/what interfered him in his work?

Ans. The flowers in the room were giving him a sudden allergy which resulted in Horace's work being interfered with.

QUESTIONS

- ii. Which magazine could have published the article mentioned in the given extract?
- (a) Paws and Claws
 - (b) Outdoors and Landscaping
 - (c) Interiors
 - (d) None of the above

QUESTIONS

Ans. (c) Interiors

QUESTIONS

- iii. Before he could think, Horace said, "Hay fever"
How would you judge the nature of the response?

Ans. The response given by Horace is spontaneous. Horace is so engrossed in his task that he does not pay attention to that fact that there is someone else present in the Grange. So, when he is asked a question, he gives an automatic response.

QUESTIONS

iv. Identify the sentence which can be an example of sarcasm from the extract.

Ans. The following sentence in the extract is an example of sarcasm
"I think you'd better see a doctor, if you're serious about your work."

QUESTIONS

13. Read the following extract carefully and answer the questions that follow.

But he never got the chance to begin his plan. By noon a policeman had arrested him for the jewel robbery at Shotover Grange. His fingerprints, for he had opened the safe without gloves, were all over the room, and no one believed him when he said that the wife of the owner of the house had asked him to open the safe for her. The wife herself, a gray-haired, sharp-tongued woman of sixty, said that the story was nonsense. Horace is now the assistant librarian in the prison. He often thinks of the charming, clever young lady who was in the same profession as he was, and who tricked him. He gets very angry when anyone talks about 'honour among thieves'.

QUESTIONS

- i. Based on the extract, choose what you think are the main feelings Horace probably has, for the young lady who tricked him, when he thinks about her?
- (a) Anger and blame
 - (b) Admiration and respect
 - (c) Respect and gratitude
 - (d) Anger and vengeance

QUESTIONS

Ans. (b) Admiration and respect

QUESTIONS

ii. Who was the wife of the owner of Shotover Grange? Was she the same person Horace had met when he broke into the Shotover Grange?

Ans. The wife of the owner of Shotover Grange was a gray-haired woman of sixty years who had a sharp tongued.
No, she was not the same person as the lady he had met that day was a charming and clever young lady.

QUESTIONS

iii. Which evidence was found at Shotover Grange that proved Horace guilty of theft?

Ans. Horace's fingerprints were found all over the safe as he opened it without gloves, which proved him guilty of theft.

QUESTIONS

iv. 'Honour among thieves' is an example of a/an _____.

Ans. idiom

QUESTIONS

14. What was the passion of Horace Danby and how did he satisfy it?

Ans. Horace Danby's hobby and passion was to collect rare and expensive books. To fulfill it or to satisfy this passion, he used to rob a safe every year and then, brought the books secretly through an agent.

QUESTIONS

15. How did Danby prepare for the robbery at Shotover Grange?

Ans. Horace Danby always planned his robberies meticulously. He prepared for the robbery at Shotover Grange by studying the house, its rooms, the electric wiring, paths and garden. He knew that the family was in London. He also knew that the servants were going out to watch a movie that afternoon. It could be opened only through a specific code and had a poorly built burglar alarm attached to it.

QUESTIONS

16. Describe the safe at Shotover Grange.

Ans. The safe at Shotover Grange was kept in the drawing room behind a poor painting. The safe had jewels worth about 15000 pounds kept in it. Because of his careful planning, Horace Danby was sure that his robbery at Shotover Grange would be a successful one. Horace expected to get at least 5000 pounds if he sold the jewels one by one.

QUESTIONS

17. Whom did Horace Danby see in the kitchen? How did they greet each other? What tact did Horace apply there?

Ans. Horace Danby saw the family dog, Sherry, in the kitchen. The dog greeted Horace by stirring, making a noise and wagging its tail in a friendly way. Horace greeted the dog by tactfully calming it down, calling it by its name and showing love to it.

QUESTIONS

18. What did Horace Danby wonder about for a moment? What did he think and decide?

Ans. On seeing the poor painting in front of the safe, Horace Danby wondered for a moment whether to collect pictures instead of books. But then, he thought that books were better in a small house like his, as paintings took up too much space in the room.

QUESTIONS

19. How did flowers hinder Horace in. his work?

Ans. Flowers hindered Horace in his work because he suffered from the attack of hay fever, a disorder affecting the nose and throat, caused by an allergy to pollen or dust. Due to this problem, whenever he came close to flowers, he began to sneeze and could be caught.

QUESTIONS

20. "Society must be protected from men like you."
Comment on the irony of the given quote.

Ans. When Horace asked the woman in red to forget the incident and let him go, she told him that if she lets him go, he would rob someone else.
Society then must be protected from men like him, i.e. robbers. The statement is ironical as she herself was a thief who deceived Horace and robbed the house.

QUESTIONS

21. What are the subtle ways in which the lady manages to deceive Horace Danby into thinking she is the mistress of the house?

Ans. The subtle ways in which the lady manages to deceive Horace Danby into thinking she is the mistress of the house are her grace, charm, comfort level, knowledge, persistence, way of talking confidently and familiarity with the household.

QUESTIONS

22. "Horace Danby is a thief who was cheated by another thief." Justify.

Ans. It is true that 'A Question of Trust' is a story about the robbery of the robber. The story essentially is about Horace Danby, a book robber who meticulously plans a robbery at Shotover Grange. But he himself is robbed of his respect and freedom when another robber tricks and deceives him into robbing the place for him.

QUESTIONS

23. What does the phrase 'honour among thieves' mean?
Why does Horace get angry at this phrase?

Ans. The phrase 'honour among thieves' means that thieves would never cheat each other in their deeds. Horace gets angry at this phrase because he got cheated by another thief while he was in the midst of his planned robbery.

QUESTIONS

24. "The lady in red was a more professional thief than Horace Danby." Elaborate.

Ans. Yes, it is true that Horace was clever but the lady in red was cleverer than him. The lady in red was a more professional thief than Horace Danby. Horace Danby is a meticulous planner who had carefully planned the robbery. He had all the information he needed to carry out his plans. He not only had read a detailed description of the house but also knew that the servants were going for a movie. Even while robbing he wore gloves and was careful not to leave any fingerprints. However, all his planning falls short with the presence of the lady in red. The lady in red also knew everything about the house.

QUESTIONS

However, her presence of mind gave her an upper hand in the robbery. The charm and confidence with which she carries herself in front of Horace make him believe that she is the owner of the house. She exploited Horace's fear of being discovered very skillfully and ensured that Horace's fingerprints were left on the site. She even robbed the safe without Horace knowing her real identity.

She not only tricked Horace Danby, but also left him to be blamed for the robbery.

QUESTIONS

25. 'Honour among thieves' is considered a popular quote. Examine 'A Question of Trust' as a story woven around this code.

Ans. It is commonly believed that thieves don't betray or double cross each other. Rather they may even help each other. This goes hand-in-hand with the protagonist of 'A Question of Trust', Horace Danby was careful whenever he conducted a theft once a year. He prepared for his thefts so well that it would have been impossible for him to be ever caught. In the story, then, his only fault was trusting the lady in red blindly. He failed to anticipate the skills of the lady in red who fooled him to commit a theft herself. The lady in red did not follow the code of honour that normally exists between two thieves even though she herself was a thief. Infact, she made a fool of him and incriminated him for a theft that she profitted from. Thus, Horace ended up going to prison for the second time in his life. He felt very betrayed by a fellow thief.

STAY CONNECTED

KEEP LEARNING

Thank You



Join our telegram channel
@ABHAY_BATC H2024BOARDS

